

Task 5

Part A – Case Study

Cybercrime Case Study – Phishing Attack

A first-year college student, Riya, received an email that appeared to be from her bank. The message stated that her account would be temporarily blocked due to suspicious activity unless she verified her details immediately. Feeling anxious, she clicked on the link provided in the email. The link redirected her to a website that looked exactly like her bank's official website. Without noticing any difference, Riya entered her username, password, and other banking details. Shortly after, she received an OTP on her phone, which she also entered on the same website, believing it was part of the verification process.

Within minutes, a large amount of money was deducted from her bank account without her authorization. When she contacted the bank, she realized that she had fallen victim to a phishing attack. The website was fake, and the attackers had used her information to access her account and transfer money.

This incident shows how phishing attacks exploit fear and urgency to trick users. Students and young users are often targeted because they actively use online services. The case highlights the importance of verifying sources, avoiding suspicious links, and never sharing sensitive information online.